

WEAPONS OF THE REVOLUTIONARY AND NAPOLEONIC WARS

Armies in the Revolutionary and Napoleonic Wars fought with a range of weapons including bayonets and cannon. The massed infantry used muskets, and only the specialist regiments of sharpshooters carried rifles. Swords were the preferred weapon in a cavalry charge, except for light cavalry regiments, who carried lances topped with pennons or flags. Many cavalymen also had two loaded pistols, for emergency use, while dragoons often regarded the carbine as their principal weapon.



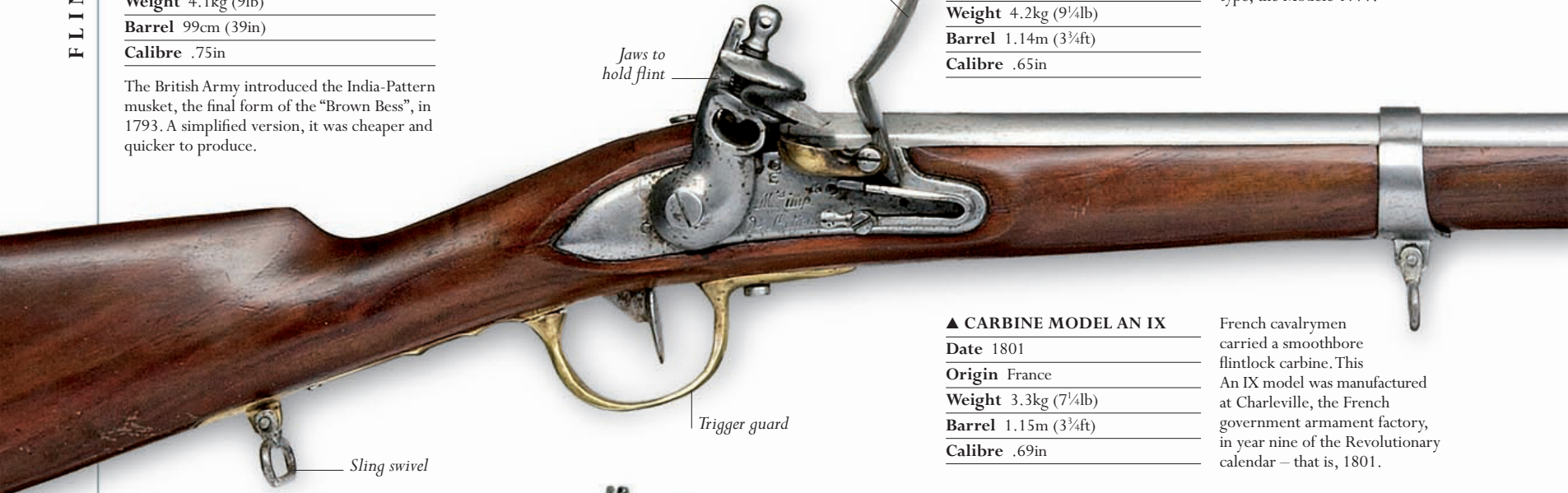
▲ INDIA-PATTERN MUSKET
Date 1797
Origin UK
Weight 4.1kg (9lb)
Barrel 99cm (39in)
Calibre .75in

The British Army introduced the India-Pattern musket, the final form of the “Brown Bess”, in 1793. A simplified version, it was cheaper and quicker to produce.



▲ AUSTRIAN MUSKET
Date 1798
Origin Austria
Weight 4.2kg (9¼lb)
Barrel 1.14m (3¾ft)
Calibre .65in

In 1798, Austria introduced a new flintlock musket to match the latest French gun of this type, the Modèle 1777.



▲ CARBINE MODEL AN IX
Date 1801
Origin France
Weight 3.3kg (7¼lb)
Barrel 1.15m (3¾ft)
Calibre .69in

French cavalymen carried a smoothbore flintlock carbine. This An IX model was manufactured at Charleville, the French government armament factory, in year nine of the Revolutionary calendar – that is, 1801.



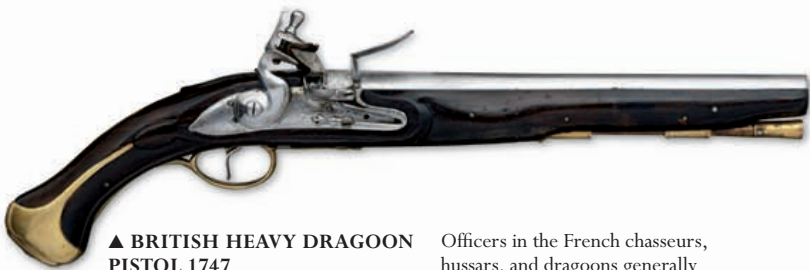
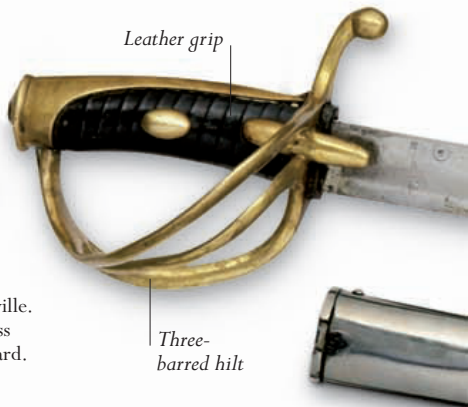
▲ HEAVY DRAGOON CARBINE PATTERN 1770
Date c.1805
Origin UK
Weight 3.9kg (8½lb)
Barrel 66cm (26in)
Calibre .75in

Napoleonic-era carbines had shorter barrels than earlier models. Each dragoon clipped the carbine to his belt, from which it hung next to the thigh.



▲ PRUSSIAN 1809 PATTERN MUSKET
Date 1809
Origin Germany
Weight 4kg (8¾lb)
Barrel 1.04m (3½ft)
Calibre .75in

The 1809 Pattern musket was the Prussian equivalent of the British Brown Bess and the French Charleville. Unlike its competitors, it had a brass flash guard around the pan as standard. Most of these flintlocks were later converted to percussion.



▲ BRITISH HEAVY DRAGOON PISTOL 1747
Date 18th century
Origin UK
Weight 1.2kg (2½lb)
Barrel 30.5cm (12in)
Calibre .65in

Officers in the French chasseurs, hussars, and dragoons generally carried flintlock pistols similar to this British example. One of a pair, it has a heavy brass butt plate, which could be used as a club in hand-to-hand fighting.

Barrel band secures the barrel to the stock